

■ 1.2 Building Up Calculations

■ 1.2.1 Using Previous Results

When you build up a calculation, you will often need to use previous results that you have got. In *Mathematica*, `%` always stands for your last result.

You will have noticed that all the input and output lines in *Mathematica* are numbered. You can use these numbers to refer to your previous results.

<code>%</code>	the last result generated
<code>%%</code>	the next-to-last result
<code>%n</code>	the result on output line <code>Out[n]</code>

Ways to refer to your previous results.

Here is the first result.

```
In[1]:= 77 ^ 2
Out[1]= 5929
```

This adds 1 to the last result.

```
In[2]:= % + 1
Out[2]= 5930
```

This uses both the last result, and the result on line 1.

```
In[3]:= 3 % + % ^ 2 + %1
Out[3]= 35188619
```

With many front ends for *Mathematica*, you can “scroll back” to see earlier parts of your session. More advanced front ends also often allow you to pick out previous results graphically, without referring to them explicitly by line numbers.